(i) The Monopolistic and Restrictive Trade Practices (MRTP) Act was passed. The Act intended to regulate the trading and commercial practices of the firms and checking monopoly and concentration of economic power.

(ii) The firms with assets of ‘25 crore or more were put under obligation of taking permission from the Government of India before any expansion, greenfield venture and takeover of other firms (as per the MRTP Act). Such firms came to be known as the ‘***MRTP Companies***’. The upper limit (known as the ‘***MRTP limit***’) for such companies was revised upward to ‘50 crore in 1980 and ‘100 crore in 1985[13].

(iii) For the redressal of the prohibited and restricted practices of trade, the Government did set up a as ***MRTP Commission***.

INDUSTRIAL POLICY STATEMENT, 1973

The Industrial policy statement of 1973 introduced some new thinking into the economy with major ones being as follows:

(i) A new classificatory term i.e. ***core industries*** was created. The industries which were of fundamental importance for the development of industries were put in this category such as iron and steel, cement, coal, crude oil, oil refining and electricity. In the future, these industries will be also known as ***basic industries, infrastructure industries*** in the country.

(ii) Out of the six core industries defined by the policy, the private sector may apply for licences for the industries which were not a part of Schedule A of the Industrial Policy, 1956[14]. The private firms eligible to apply for such licences were supposed to have their total assets at `20 crore or more.

(iii) Some industries were put under the ***reserved list*** in which only the small or medium industries could be set up[15].